



SEARCH & AI VISIBILITY STRATEGY

The Align HCM ranking roadmap.

Everything we can do to rank higher and get cited by AI answer engines — what's done, what's next, and what to expect.
Grounded in your live HubSpot data.



1 • WHERE YOU STAND TODAY

The honest snapshot

Real numbers from your HubSpot analytics (trailing 30 days). This is the baseline we measure everything against.

1,928

page views / 30 days

42

form submissions

21

leads captured

~85%

aggregate bounce rate

9 / 63

blog posts fully optimized

What the data says. Your money pages already work — the Home page pulls the most traffic and the Contact page converts hard (15 of 42 submissions came from one page). The two highest-traffic blog posts are the UKG and Workday buyer's guides, which tells us buyer-intent content is what earns visits. The gaps: a high bounce rate signals visitors aren't being routed deeper into the site, and 54 of 63 blog posts still lack the structure search engines and AI need to surface them.

The core problem isn't content quality — it's legibility and depth. You have strong content that machines can't fully read and visitors can't easily navigate. Both are fixable, and we've started.

What actually moves rankings

Ranking and AI-citation come down to four levers. We control the first two outright; the third compounds over time; the fourth is the emerging channel where we can win fastest.

① On-page & content IN PROGRESS

Highest leverage · we control it fully

- **Finish the cluster.** Optimize the remaining Tier-1 & Tier-2 posts the way we did the first 9 — direct answers, question headings, FAQ, internal links, schema.
- **Title tags & meta descriptions.** Rewrite every blog title/meta around the exact phrase buyers search (e.g. “UKG implementation partner,” “Workday reporting best practices”).
- **Internal-link architecture.** Every post links to its platform guide, the pillar page, and 1–2 siblings — this is topical authority, and it lifts the whole site, not one page.
- **Bottom-funnel pages.** Comparison and “vs” content (Paylocity vs Paychex, UKG vs Workday) plus buyer’s guides capture high-intent searches close to a purchase decision.
- **Content depth & freshness.** Expand thin posts past 900 words; refresh the top guides quarterly so they stay current.

② Technical SEO NEXT

Removes the reasons Google won’t rank you · we control it

- **Site & entity schema.** Add Organization + WebSite + LocalBusiness schema sitewide with sameAs links (LinkedIn, socials) so Google understands the Align HCM brand entity. (Post-level BlogPosting/FAQPage schema is already going on.)

- **llms.txt + robots.txt.** Publish an llms.txt that tells AI crawlers what to read, and confirm robots.txt allows the AI bots (GPTBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended).
- **Core Web Vitals.** Audit load speed, mobile layout, and image sizes — HubSpot themes often ship heavy. Speed is a ranking factor and a bounce-rate lever.
- **Crawl hygiene.** Clean XML sitemap, fix duplicate/near-duplicate posts (there are a few duplicate titles in the blog), canonical tags, and internal 404s.
- **Mobile.** Ship the mobile menu system sitewide (already built) — mobile UX feeds both rankings and conversion.

③ Off-page & authority SLOWER BURN

The half schema can't replace · compounds over months

- **Backlinks.** Earn links from HR/payroll publications, partner sites (UKG/Workday/Dayforce partner directories), and industry roundups. Domain authority is why competitors outrank equal content.
- **Digital PR & guest posts.** Byline articles and expert quotes (HARO-style) on HR-tech sites build both links and brand searches.
- **Partner co-marketing.** Get listed and linked in the official implementation-partner directories for each platform you serve.
- **Google Business Profile & citations.** Consistent NAP (name/address/phone) across directories strengthens the brand entity and local intent.

④ AEO / GEO — getting cited by AI WINNING FASTEST

The emerging channel · fastest realistic wins

- **Extractable answers.** The direct-answer callouts + FAQ we're adding are exactly what ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews quote. AI engines re-crawl constantly and don't need domain authority the way blue-link ranking does.

- **Structured data.** FAQPage + BlogPosting schema tells AI systems precisely what each page answers.
- **Question-shaped content.** Headings phrased the way people actually ask (“What is UKG Rapid Hire?”) match LLM query patterns.
- **Be the cited source.** Original data, checklists, and definitive guides get referenced more than generic advice — lean into Align’s implementation expertise.
- **Track citations.** The daily tracker probes target queries and watches for AI-referral traffic so we know it’s working.

Prioritized 90-day roadmap

Sequenced by leverage-per-effort. Cheapest, highest-impact work first.

Phase	Work	Why it's ordered here
Done	9 posts fully optimized (schema, FAQ, links, direct answers)	Proves the system and starts the compounding.
Now (wk 1–2)	Internal-link sweep across the 17 orphan posts · finish Tier-1 optimization · rewrite titles/meta on top 20 posts	Pure on-page, fully in our control, lifts the whole cluster.
30 days	Sitewide entity schema + llms.txt + robots.txt for AI crawlers · Core Web Vitals audit · fix duplicate posts & sitemap	Removes technical blockers so the on-page work can rank.
60 days	Buyer's guides + comparison/"vs" pages for bottom-funnel keywords · expand thin posts	Captures high-intent, close-to-purchase searches.
90 days	Backlink & partner-directory push · digital PR · GBP + citations	Authority takes longest to build — start it early, expect payoff later.
Ongoing	Daily tracker (leads + traffic + AI/search visibility) · quarterly content refresh	Measure, don't guess; keep the top pages current.

What to expect, and how we'll know

Realistic timeline

- **Weeks:** AI-citation lift (ChatGPT/Perplexity/AI Overviews) and rich-result eligibility. This is the fastest channel.
- **1–2 months:** Movement on long-tail and question keywords as Google re-crawls the optimized posts.
- **3–6 months:** Competitive head-term rankings, once cluster depth + authority accumulate.

The honest truth: on-page work removes the reasons you're not ranking; authority and time do the rest. Five posts won't move the domain — the whole program will.

KPIs we'll track daily

- Leads & form submissions (the number that pays the bills)
- Organic page views & trend vs prior period
- AI-visibility score — how many target queries we appear for
- Near-miss keywords (page 2 → page 1 opportunities)
- AI-referral traffic (ChatGPT / Perplexity / Gemini sources)
- Optimization coverage (posts with schema/FAQ/links)

Delivered every morning at 10 AM ET via the automated tracker, with a report committed to the vault.

Bottom line. We control on-page and technical SEO outright and have already started — that's the highest-leverage, fastest-compounding work. AEO/GEO is the channel where a focused consultancy like Align can out-punch bigger competitors quickly, because AI engines reward clear, structured, expert answers over raw domain size. Authority (backlinks) is the long game we start now and harvest later. Ranking is a program, not a switch — but every piece here is a lever we can actually pull.

Align HCM · alignhcm.com · Ranking Roadmap 2026-07-09